

Garage Door Repair Bill Shock — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

VERIFY DOOR COMPONENTS MANUALLY

- ☐ **Pull the emergency release cord and lift the door by hand to determine if the springs are intact or if the problem is in the opener; if the door feels abnormally heavy, the springs have failed.:** Pull the emergency release cord and lift the door by hand to determine if the springs are intact or if the problem is in the opener; if the door feels abnormally heavy, the springs have failed.
- ☐ **Listen to whether the motor runs while the door stays stationary, which points to a worn drive gear or sprocket rather than a complete motor failure.:** Listen to whether the motor runs while the door stays stationary, which points to a worn drive gear or sprocket rather than a complete motor failure.
- ☐ **Consult a parts cost reference table so you can recognize when a contractor's quoted price represents fair markup versus excessive profit.:** Consult a parts cost reference table so you can recognize when a contractor's quoted price represents fair markup versus excessive profit.
- ☐ **Request itemized quotes that clearly separate parts cost from labor cost so you understand exactly where your money goes.:** Request itemized quotes that clearly separate parts cost from labor cost so you understand exactly where your money goes.

KNOW FAIR REPAIR COSTS

- ☐ **Ask every contractor recommending replacement what a comparable repair would cost, since they may suggest full replacement for higher profit margins.:** Ask every contractor recommending replacement what a comparable repair would cost, since they may suggest full replacement for higher profit margins.
- ☐ **Get three written bids for any repair estimate over \$300 to establish fair market value and identify inflated quotes.:** Get three written bids for any repair estimate over \$300 to establish fair market value and identify inflated quotes.
- ☐ **Verify the exact part name and model number instead of accepting vague terms like 'the mechanism' — this ensures you're comparing apples to apples across contractors.:** Verify the exact part name and model number instead of accepting vague terms like 'the mechanism' — this ensures you're comparing apples to apples across contractors.

- **Walk away from contractors who refuse to provide written itemized quotes or who pressure you to commit immediately on the spot.:** Walk away from contractors who refuse to provide written itemized quotes or who pressure you to commit immediately on the spot.

GET QUOTES THAT COMPETE

- **Perform the 5-minute sensor alignment fix yourself before calling anyone when the door closes and immediately reopens, since this resolves half of these service calls at zero cost.:** Perform the 5-minute sensor alignment fix yourself before calling anyone when the door closes and immediately reopens, since this resolves half of these service calls at zero cost.
- **Check the Full Guide:** This step is described in detail in the companion guide — open garage-door-repair-bill-shock_v1.md and review the relevant section.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.